invasion? While he was aware of the dual-capable systems, there is no convincing evidence that this informed his thinking.[88]

In February 1963 DCI McCone reported to President Kennedy that 'every major weapons system introduced into Cuba by the Soviets was detected, identified, and reported (with respect to numbers, location and operational characteristics) before any of these systems attained an operational capability.'[89] It is now clear that assurance was mistaken. At the 1992 Havana conference General Gribkov dramatically revealed that Soviet tactical nuclear weapons were deployed in Cuba. Major-General Gribkov was one of the handful of General Staff officers responsible for planning Operation Anadyr. In October 1962 he was sent to Cuba as the representative of the General Staff to oversee completion of the deployment. At the Havana conference attention focused on Gribkov's suggestion that the commander of Soviet forces in Cuba, General Issa Pliyev, was given authority by Nikita Khrushchev to use them in an invasion.[90]

Initially, Khrushchev decided to delegate this authority. It is now clear that he changed his mind. Authority to use *any* nuclear weapons remained with the Presidium. This was communicated to General Pliyev on both 22 and 27 October. Yet regardless of whether Pliyev had authority, the only safeguards against unauthorised use were procedural. If the US invaded, decisions to use nuclear weapons could have been taken by the troops under attack. This assumes, of course, that the weapons and their crews survived, and that the warheads could be delivered and fitted to the missiles. The nuclear-capable Ilyushin-28s remained in their crates at Holguin airfield (while US intelligence remained oblivious to their purpose). Any prospect of them surviving an air attack, being assembled to combat readiness, receiving delivery of their Tatyana bombs, and getting off the ground, would surely have been negligible.

While General Gribkov was naturally keen to emphasise the discipline of Soviet troops, he nevertheless suggested:

> Under combat conditions, in the terrible disorder of the battlefield, there is an outside possibility that an enterprising